

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN PRIMARY SCHOOLS

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE

The E' Class English Language Coursebook is proposed by the Pedagogical Institute as a tool to support the teaching and learning processes in the Greek State Primary School. Coursebook design and content are based upon the principles of literacy, plurilingualism and pluriculturalism, as set by the Cross-curricular Unified Framework (2003).

This coursebook is based on thematic units, which, we believe, will attract the interests of the E' Class pupils. Moreover, the teachers who will introduce the coursebook into the classroom procedure should consider the pupils' specific needs as well as the needs of the local community. For example, a coursebook unit that explores the environmental issue should be tailored in order to reflect local problems and the particular pupils' interests. In other words, no coursebook can be the sole source of knowledge. During the course of implementation of each thematic unit, the cross-curricular element will emerge within the framework of a well-structured and organized project. Projects will enable pupils to explore issues such as local history or the natural characteristics of the eco-system (flora and fauna) in order to offer solutions aiming to improve living conditions in the area. The solutions will emerge through the learners' involvement in the local affairs as social agents and active citizens. This process will facilitate the holistic approach of knowledge and the deep understanding of fundamental cross-curricular concepts (e.g. similarity, difference, space etc). In this way the realistic element of English language teaching will prevail and the value of the foreign language as a communication medium as well as a tool for the development of ideas, values and emotions will be established.

THE CROSS - THEMATIC / CROSS - CURRICULAR APPROACH

The cross - thematic / cross - curricular approach enables pupils to acquire a unified body of knowledge and skills, following a holistic approach to knowledge. This approach will allow them to form their own personal opinions on scientific issues that are closely interrelated and are also related with issues of everyday life. In this way, pupils can form their own perception of the world, their own 'Cosmo' theory and their own opinions about the world they should get to know, love and live in. The cross - thematic / cross - curricular approach is supplemented by methods of active acquisition of knowledge, which are applied in the teaching of individual subjects, and are further explored during cross-thematic activities which take place during the teaching of each theme.

Fundamental concepts

Fundamental concepts (e.g. similarity - difference / system / communication / time - place / culture - civilization / interaction - change - evolution, etc) can be explored across various scientific fields and can facilitate the horizontal linking of school subjects. Some fundamental concepts that can be called cross-thematic are common in several subjects of the same grade, often appear in school subjects of different classes and can contribute to the promotion of attitudes and values that are directly related to the main aims of school education. The combination of the above concepts by adopting relevant practices facilitates the implementation of the cross - thematic approach, as it highlights the pupil's multidimensional perception of the world.

METHODOLOGICAL TIPS

The following Methodological Tips are here to help you make the most of your teaching. Remember there is no one right way to teach. The key aim is to become aware of what is possible. The act of teaching is essentially a constant process of choosing between different options. The tips offered here are a means of enriching your list of options. By following the guidelines, together with a little inspiration, these should be of assistance to make your lessons more rewarding, both for you and for your pupils.

1. MULTIPLE INTELLIGENCES

Every learner adopts an individual style, or a mixture of styles, in order to (re)construct knowledge. Therefore, during the classroom procedures it is difficult for teachers to assess the degree of new knowledge pupils have conquered. On the contrary, learners should be treated as individuals, who bring their own unique characteristics, e.g. rhythm, pace, style, to the learning process (Gardner 1983). Howard Gardner proposes a new view of intelligence which goes beyond the older

concept of IQ which focused on mathematical and linguistic abilities.

- His new intelligence areas includes: Logical-Mathematical, Linguistic, Spatial, Musical, Bodily-Kinaesthetic, Inter-personal, Intra-personal and Naturalistic Intelligence. Daniel Coleman added Emotional Intelligence.

2. LANGUAGE LEARNING STRATEGY DEFINITIONS

Foreign language learning strategies are specific actions, behaviours, steps or techniques which pupils use – often consciously – to improve their progress in apprehending, internalizing and using L2. Research has repeatedly shown that the conscious, tailored use of such strategies is related to successful language achievement and proficiency. Well-tailored combinations of these strategies have a much greater impact than single strategies. There are different classification systems. We show here one of the most complete systems, devised by O'Malley & Chamot, where they have divided the strategies into Metacognitive, Social Affective and Cognitive.

A. Metacognitive Strategies

Metacognitive strategies involve thinking about the learning process, planning for learning, monitoring the learning task, and evaluating how well one has learned.

1. Advanced Organization

Previewing the main idea and concepts of the material to be learned, often by skimming the text for the organizing principle.

2. Organizational Planning

Planning the parts, sequence, main ideas, or language functions to be expressed orally or in writing.

3. Directed Attention

Deciding in advance to attend in general to a learning task and to ignore irrelevant distracters.

4. Selective Attention

Deciding in advance to attend to specific aspects of input, often by scanning for key words, concepts, and/or linguistic markers.

5. Self-monitoring

Checking one's comprehension during listening or reading, or checking the accuracy and/or appropriateness of one's oral or written production while it is taking place.

6. Self-evaluation

Judging how well one has accomplished a learning activity after it has been completed.

7. Self-management

Understanding the conditions that help one learn and arranging for the presence of those conditions.

B. Social Affective Strategies

Social and affective strategies involve interacting with another person to assist learning, or using affective control to assist a learning task.

1. Questions for Clarification

Eliciting from teacher or peer additional explanation, rephrasing, or verification.

2. Cooperation

Working together with peers to solve a problem, pool information, check a learning task, model a language activity, or get feedback on oral or written performance.

3. Self-talk

Reducing anxiety by using mental techniques that make one feel competent to do the learning task.

4. Self-reinforcement

Providing personal motivation by arranging

rewards for oneself when a language learning activity has been completed successfully.

C. Cognitive Strategies

Cognitive strategies involve interacting with the material to be learned, manipulating the material mentally or physically, or applying a specific technique to a learning task.

1. Repetition

Imitating a language model exactly including oral practice, silent practice or copying.

2. Rehearsal

Rehearsing the language needed, with attention to meaning, for an oral or written task.

3. Resourcing

Using target language reference materials such as dictionaries, encyclopedias, or textbooks.

4. Translation

Using the first language as a base for understanding and/or producing the second language.

5. Grouping

Classifying words, terminology or concepts according to their attributes.

6. Substitution

Using a replacement target language word or phrase when the intended word or phrase is not available.

7. Note-taking

Writing down key words and concepts in

Based on Chamot, O' Malley et als. 1987

abbreviated verbal, graphic, or numerical form during a listening or reading activity.

8. Summarizing

Making a mental or written summary of information gained through listening or reading.

9. Deduction/Induction

Applying rules to understand or produce the second language.

10. Imagery

Using visual images to (either mental or actual) understand and remember new information.

11. Auditory Representation

Playing back in one's mind the sound of a word, phrase or longer language sequence.

12. Contextualization

Assisting comprehension or recall by placing a word or phrase in a meaningful language sequence or situational context.

13. Elaboration

Relating new information to prior knowledge, relating different parts of new information to each other, or making meaningful personal associations to the new information

14. Transfer

Using previous linguistics knowledge or prior skills to assist comprehension or production.

15. Inferencing

Using information in an oral or written text to guess meanings, predict outcomes, or complete missing parts.

3. DIFFERENTIATION

In the classroom we usually work with pupils who have reached different levels of language competences or who have special learning needs. To offer our pupils the opportunity to take full advantage of the classroom experience, we should design tasks of varying degree of difficulty, i.e. tasks that can be adapted depending on specific learner needs.

3.A. Principles of Differentiated Teaching

- Differentiation aims at maximising learning and development of each student.
- In a differentiated classroom pupils are matched with tasks according to their individual learner needs.
- Open-ended tasks i.e. tasks that allow for multiple right answers, such as 'predict

the content of a text from its title', 'write a paragraph', 'role-play', 'put the items in order of importance or preference', 'projects' etc. are particularly appropriate for mixed-ability classes because students can produce language at their own level. Closed tasks are less appropriate.

- Pupils can work in groups of similar competence level (homogeneous groups) when doing 'tiered tasks'. Tiered tasks are those where one has two or three versions of the same task varying in terms of difficulty.
- Flexible classroom organization is a 'must' for differentiation.

3.B. Tiered tasks

Tiered tasks in the Appendix are to be used by groups of pupils or even the whole class

instead of their versions in the main part of the book. If the class or some pupils find a task in the book too easy or too difficult, they can choose not to do this task and try a more difficult or easier version of the task in the Appendix.

When doing tiered tasks it is advisable for you to split the class in more or less homogeneous groups i.e. groups of pupils of similar competence level in the specific area and objective on which the task focuses.

3.C. Projects

Projects are based on the principles of experiential and collaborative learning. As such, their main aim is to enable learners to learn by doing in order to enhance their critical thinking and interactive skills while their implementation presupposes work in teams. Therefore, for maximum active participation, learners should:

- be exposed to collaborative and cooperative work and reflect upon their role and contributions as team members;
- take initiatives, decide and agree on a topic; select sub-topics;
- conduct research, plan, organize, read, write, interact, compile, present, perform, publish their own work and
- evaluate the process as well as the end product.

Projects are open-ended and flexible and therefore provide an excellent basis for differentiating teaching/learning. For example, at the research stage of a project, more competent learners can work on more difficult texts, or with less teacher support. Furthermore, some pupils might prefer to work alone, while others might work in groups. Another example of differentiation, where we also apply the Multiple Intelligences Theory, is as follows. In a project on sports activities one group of pupils might be guided to demonstrate a sport as a kinaesthetic option, another group of visual-spatial learners could collaborate on designing a poster with the rules for the sport, and another group of students with verbal-linguistic intelligence could develop a

report on the sport.

3.D. Language Awareness Activities

Language awareness activities guide pupils in noticing useful language forms in the text used in the specific lesson or in texts read in previous lessons (or in sentences assembled from previously read texts). They are more appropriate for mixed-ability classes.

Examples of language awareness activities:

- Pupils underline in the text(s) words that end in -s or -'s and put them in categories e.g. plural nouns, simple present, is, has, genitive
- pupils underline in the text(s) words that end in -ing and put them in categories
- pupils underline in the text(s) phrases with the preposition 'in' and put them in two categories: time and place
- pupils underline in the text(s) the adjectives that are used to describe the nouns

3.E. Alternative assessment

- Differentiation is compatible with alternative assessment and self-assessment, e.g. portfolio, learner diaries, can-do-statements etc. in the CEFR (2001)
- Such types of assessment are growth-referenced, that is, they function as a progress map recording and monitoring a pupil's improvement over time, and are not based on a comparison of each learner's performance with that of the other pupils (norm-referenced assessment).

DIFFERENTIATION

Teacher's Book references:

- **Projects:** see p. 24, 28, 31, 41, 53, 65, 73
- **Tiered Tasks:**
 - PB Appendix: from p. 133 to p. 152
 - AB Appendix: from p. 64 to p. 86

4. SKILLS

According to current relevant literature and research, one of the main goals of language teaching nowadays concerns the development of receptive (i.e. of reading and listening) and productive skills (i.e. of writing, speaking, oral interaction and communication). A skills-based approach

requires that the teacher integrate into the syllabus activities aiming to enable pupils to view learning as a process. This process involves the activation of natural acquisition mechanisms through the development of reading, writing, listening and oral communication strategies.

4.1 READING

4.1.A. Extensive reading

- Simplified Readers
 - The use of simplified readers can be successful because the readers are graded for grammar and vocabulary. This helps the pupils read with greater ease and confidence.
 - We recommend that classes have simplified reader libraries. The readers should be coded for level and genre and should have a signing out system to keep track of which pupils have borrowed which readers.
 - See recommended list of simplified readers in TB p. 140.
- Extensive Reading tasks
 - Set aside time, say every 2 weeks, when pupils can report back and tell their classmates about the books they are reading
 - Pupils keep a weekly reading diary
 - Ask the pupils to write short book reviews
 - Have a comment sheet inside each reader
 - Ask pupils to draw a picture of a scene
 - Map the story
 - Discuss whether the story would make a good film

4.1.B. Intensive Reading

- Ideas for Intensive Reading tasks
 - Put the illustrations of the text in the correct order
 - Put the cut up paragraphs in the correct order
 - Read the texts and find the mistakes in the illustrations (pupils draw illustrations with mistakes)
 - Read the text and make a list of items which appear therein
 - Give a headline to each section of the

passage

- Find the appropriate places in the text to re-insert some sentences that have been previously taken out of the text
- Predict which of the following words you will find in the text
- Solve the problem
- Discuss the missing last paragraph
- Discuss feelings about the text
- Before reading the text make notes about what you already know about it
- Act out the text
- Put the list of events in the correct order
- Reading on the Internet
 - By reading texts on the Internet pupils have the advantage of accessing authentic information. Possible websites of interest:
 - Virtual museums for projects
 - Geographical information
 - Song lyrics of favourite music tracks
 - Films
 - Timetables
 - Daily news
 - Weather reports

4.1.C. Reading out loud in class

Reading aloud around the class can be tedious and end up being boring. Here are a few alternatives to make it interesting:

- Teacher reads
- Teacher reads narrative and pupils read dialogues
- Having read a story, get the pupils to retell it.
- Pupils read to each other in small groups
- Pupils read silently and then improve it by acting out part of the story.
- Silently speed-reading chapters.

READING Teacher's Book references:

- Intensive: p. 19, 21, 23, 24, 26, 29, 31, 35, 40, 49, 51, 52, 62, 64, 68, 69, 70
- Extensive: See list of readers p. 140

4.2 WRITING

4.2.A. Types of Writing

- Doing exercises: Pupils write single words or short sentences. Focus here is on accuracy.
- Guided writing: Pupils write longer passages following clear guidelines.

- Process writing: With the help and feedback from the teacher and classmates on the various stages of writing, pupils write what they want.
- Unguided writing: After choosing a topic, pupils are freer to write what they want. Focus here is on fluency.

4.2.B. Writing as a process (steps to be followed)

For the development of the writing skill to happen successfully, it is important to go through the right preparatory steps, which could be some or all of the following:

- Introduce the topic and writing task
- Brainstorm ideas
- Write the topic on the board
- Ask pupils to tell you everything that comes to mind on the topic
- Write everything on the board
- No discussion or comments at this stage
- Try fast writing
- Just start writing about the topic, even if it is rubbish. This helps to overcome the block which many people have
- Sort and order ideas
- Decide on specific requirements
- Focus on useful models
- If it's a letter, give the pupils a model letter
- If it's a report, maybe show pupils the way an authentic report is laid out from an Internet site
- Plan the text
- Use bits of paper and then organise it in a logical sequence
- Prepare draft
- Edit
- Prepare final text

4.2.C. Examples of Writing tasks

- Write a guide book about your own town or a place you know well
- Write about a product you know well

4.2.D. There are a number of advantages in using computers to develop Writing

- Multiple copies can be printed
- Editing is easily done
- Drafts can be sent electronically to other pupils

WRITING Teacher's Book references:

- Writing exercises: p. 23, 39
- Guided writing: p. 20, 23, 27, 29, 37, 39, 50, 62, 64, 65, 70, 73
- Process writing: p. 21, 35, 60

4.3 LISTENING

4.3.A. Guidelines for Listening in class

- Keep the recordings short
- Play the recordings a sufficient number of times
- Play little bits of the recording
- Give help when pupils are stuck
- Make sure the tasks are manageable: don't change the tasks during the listening
- Grade the task and not the recording. In theory it is possible to offer authentic listening passages at a beginner level

4.3.B. Different Skills - which also apply to Reading

- Identifying the topic
- Predicting the topic
- Listening (& Reading) for general understanding
- Listening for gist: Pupils get an overall impression without worrying about the detail
- Skimming: Pupils find key topics, main ideas, themes and basic structure
- Listening (& Reading) for specific information
- Scanning: Pupils look for individual pieces of information

4.3.C. Possible Listening Tasks

- Follow the route on the map
- Choose the best answer from the options given
- Match the people to the pictures

4.3.D. Sequence of Steps for a Listening lesson

- Discuss the general topic
- Predict the specific content
- Predict the structure: e.g. if it's a radio talk show, it will be based on questions and answers.
- Gist listening for overview
- More careful listening for detail or complex meaning
- Listening again to pick out specific

language details

4.3.E. Authentic songs in the classroom

- Listen and discuss: Get the pupils to express their opinions on the lyrics.
- Gapped text: Give the pupils the lyrics with some words blanked out.
- Song jumble: Photocopy and cut up the lyrics. The pupils reorder the text.
- Sing along: Useful to practice stress and rhythm.

4.3.F. Authentic language

- Listen to many different pronunciations.
- Listen to the English language as lingua franca.

LISTENING Teacher's Book references:

- **Listening for Specific information:** p. 19, 21, 27, 28, 36, 38, 49, 51, 52, 58, 60, 63, 68, 71

4.4. SPEAKING

4.4.A. The Role of the Teacher

During a Speaking activity you can play the following roles:

- *Prompter*: It is important for you to support pupils who may be struggling. See "Scaffolding" below.
- *Participant*: If you participate in role plays for example, you can add to liveliness and help generate enthusiasm for the activity. However you need to be careful not to dominate the activity. A discreet presence is advised.
- *Feedback provider*: When should the feedback be given, during the activity or at the end? It may be useful to give it during the activity, if given with tact and appropriacy.
- *"Scaffolding"*: This refers to the way a competent language speaker can help a less competent language learner by "building" their conversation. Examples:
 - Maintaining a high level of interest and understanding: nodding, agreeing, saying "yes" regularly.
 - Asking for clarification when something is unclear.
 - Discrete echoing, i.e. repetition of the final word or phrase.

- Asking very short "conversation-oiling" questions.
- Making very unobtrusive corrections (structures/ lexis/ pronunciation), where it is necessary for the communicative sense of the conversation.
- Offering a word the speaker may be having trouble in finding.

4.4.B. Communication Activities

- **Role Plays**
 - Role cards should give information about each pupil's role as well as points relevant to the task
 - Role cards should be set up in such a way as to get pupils to practice specific grammar points
 - To ensure the success of the role-play activity, make sure pupils have fully understood the task, their roles. Don't forget to give pupils sufficient preparation time.
- **Discussions**:
 - Bring a topic to class
 - Ask open-ended questions
 - Give pupils time to formulate responses
 - Feel free to play the devil's advocate if the conversation stalls.
- **Questionnaires**: These may be useful to practise repetitive language patterns.
- **Group planning**: e.g. The class plans a long weekend trip to the Zagorochoria.
- **Pyramid Discussion**: e.g. What would be the 3 most useful items to have if you were lost in the jungle? Pupils start discussions and reach a consensus in pairs, then in 4s then in 8s and so on until you reach the whole class.
- **Puzzles and Problems**: There are many books on the market with puzzles and these are a highly motivating way of getting of pupils to exchange ideas and solve tasks.

SPEAKING Teacher's Book references:

- **Pairwork**: p. 18, 20, 62, 70
- **Role Plays**: p. 27, 38, 52, 59
- **Discussions**: p. 23, 26, 32
- **Questionnaires**: p. 29, 61
- **Group Planning**: p. 53, 62, 64, 69
- **Games**: p. 36, 38, 39, 65

5. GRAMMAR

5.A. What pupils need to do in order to assimilate new grammar:

1. **Be exposed:** Through reading and listening activities expose pupils to lots of language.
2. **Notice:** Provide exercises and texts so pupils can see structures and patterns of language use.
3. **Understand the form, meaning and use:** Through exercises and charts focus the learners' attention on form and use of the grammar points.
4. **Try things out:** Give the pupils the appropriate contexts for them to try out the structures.
5. **Remember items:** Through revision and recycling, repeatedly return to the grammar items taught.

5.B. Grammar can be presented through Situational Presentation. Steps:

1. **Establish Context:** This can be done using matchstick drawings
2. **Establish meaning of target form:** Add other people or objects to present the target form.
3. **Introduce and practice target language:** Get one pupil to arrive at target structure.
4. **Generate more sentences from the context:** Get other pupils to generate similar sentences using other prompts on the board.
5. **Recording it in notebooks:** Pupils record the structure in their notebooks.

5.C. Examples of other ways to present new grammar:

1. **Self-directed discovery:** Pupils learn on their own.
 - Pupils go to a language learning Internet site and learn all about a grammar topic.
 - You hand out a list of 20 sentences with the same grammar phenomenon and get pupils to write the rules.
2. **Explanation:** You tell the learners the grammar phenomenon.
 - You tell a story about a weekend. Every time you use the verb in the past simple

you write it on the board. At the end, you write Past Simple above the list of verbs.

- You present the Past Simple in a chart form.
3. **Guided discovery:** You facilitate the learner to learn by himself
 - You present a situation then ask pupils to give you a series of sentences using the same structure.
 - You draw timelines on the board. You elicit sentences using verbs in different tenses: ask pupils to correct errors.

5.D. Practice: Controlled Output

1. Drill types:

- a. Substitution: The teacher can vary what needs to be substituted, thus increasing or decreasing difficulty.
 - b. Transformation: More difficult than substitution, here the pupil transforms the sentence from one kind into another.
 - c. True sentences: Pupils give real information, using the target structure.
2. **Written exercises:** The following are different ways one can do written exercises:
 - a. Individually
 - b. In pairs
 - c. In small groups
 - d. In teams and as a competition
 - e. Make a game out of it, e.g. in Twenty Questions pupils practice the question form creating questions with Yes/No answers.

5.E. Examples of Grammar Activities

1. **Split sentences:** Get pupils to match the phrases from two 2 columns.
2. **Grammar quiz:** Ask pupils for Past Simple and Past Participle of selected irregular verbs. See list in TB.
3. **Memory test:** To practice Present Continuous, show pupils a picture of people doing different things for 10 seconds and then ask pupils to tell you from memory what was happening.
4. **Picture dictation:** Pupils draw picture as one pupil describes a scene to them.
5. **Growing stories:** Start one story and pupils add sentences in turn to build up the story. This can be done on folded pieces of paper, where pupils add

sentences without knowing what was written before. For some fun, read them out to the class afterwards.

6. Questionnaires: Pupils compile their own questionnaires.

GRAMMAR Teacher's Book references:

- Grammar Focus: p. 20, 22, 27, 29, 37, 39, 50, 52, 60, 63, 69, 72

6. VOCABULARY

Teaching language is associated with a specific context. As we use language in order to communicate, our identity of a reflective practitioner urges us to focus on the following factors within a given communicative situation: sender, message and receiver.

6.A. Key points:

- It is important that Vocabulary is taught in its own right and is not always tagged onto Grammar or Skills activities.
- You must continue to practise Vocabulary: The teaching of Vocabulary does not end once meanings have been explained and understood by the pupils. Your responsibility is that of:
 - continuing to practise lexical items
 - introducing new contexts where it might be taught
 - adding other words which might be used in conjunction with that word
 - training pupils to use monolingual dictionaries
 - training pupils to understand the difference between receptive vocabulary (words which we need to recognize and understand) and productive vocabulary (items which we need to use on a regular basis). At the lower levels this distinction will be less marked.

6.B. Pre-teaching Vocabulary, before Listening or Reading activity

Before doing a Listening or Reading passage, you may want to use some of the following ideas to pre-teach Vocabulary.

- Brainstorm words linked into the topic area
- Match the words with the picture
- Predict which words may come up in the passage

- Check the meanings in a dictionary

6.C. Vocabulary during Listening or Reading work

- Deal with the item which a pupil may specifically ask for or not deal with it
- Offer help individually rather than to the whole class
- Give brief concise explanations

6.D. Vocabulary after Listening or Reading work

- Get pupils to guess the meaning from the context
- List words which belong to a similar group
- Give the opposites of words
- Find different words which the writer uses to describe the same things.

6.E. Helpful ways of recording Vocabulary

- Lexical item list: this could include columns with lexical item, pronunciation, translation, grammar, collocations and maybe an image
- Create a mind map grouping words
- Create topic webs
- What are other points which may be of interest about a lexical item:
 - Number of syllables
 - The semantic space it occupies, e.g. the differences between *difficult*, *hard*, *demanding* etc.
 - Any false friends in Greek
 - Lexical families, i.e. other words related by topic e.g. car, tyre, steering wheel etc.
 - Lexical sets, i.e. other words related by meaning e.g. car, automobile, vehicle etc.
 - Any homonyms
 - Prefixes and suffixes the word can take

VOCABULARY Teacher's Book references:

- Vocabulary: p. 22, 24, 40

7. TESTING PUPILS

7.A. We use 3 different types of tests:

- **Placement:** Used to assess the level of new pupils.
- **Diagnostic:** Used during to identify learner difficulties, gaps in knowledge etc.
- **Progress:** Used to measure pupils' progress in relation to the agreed syllabus.

7.B. Tests should be:

- **Valid:** Tests should test only what they are supposed to test.
- **Reliable:** A good test gives consistent results. For example if a group of pupils took the same test after 2 days, the results should be the same.
- **Practical:** Easy to mark.

7.C. There are generally 2 types of questions:

- **Discrete-item tasks:** they test specific language items, e.g. multiple choice.
- **Integrative tasks:** here a number of items or skills are tested in the same question, e.g. an extended writing task.

7.D. The following Test Type items could be included when writing your own tests

- Fill in the blanks
- Multiple Choice questions
- Cloze sentences
- Sentence transformations
- Sentence re-ordering
- Sentence construction
- Correcting mistakes

7.E. When preparing your own tests:

- **Assess the test situation:** how long should the test be
- **Decide what to test:** list what to include/exclude in the test
- **Balance the elements:** decide on how long you want each section of the test to be and what test type items to include
- **Weight the scores:** if we want to give equal weighting to the different sections it is essential to balance the marking scheme.
- **Test the test on fellow teachers:** it is good idea to try the test out on colleagues, to see if it works, before giving out to the pupils.

TESTS references:

- **PB - Self-Assessment Tests:** p. 23, 35, 47, 59, 71, 83
- **TB - Progress Tests:** p. 43, 75

8. PORTFOLIO WORK

Portfolio is an alternative type of assessment and a language passport that can accompany any foreign language learner who is interested

in presenting his/her skills. It is actually a language learning 'biography' dossier that can include evidence of the individual learner style(s), level of strategy development, level of language proficiency and collections of individual or group work products.

- This should be a **collection** of work done by pupils to show their commitment to learning the language, show progress achieved, show strengths.

- Pupils should feel a sense of ownership of their portfolio and be proud of it. It is your responsibility to ensure this takes place.

- Examples of different types of work:

- **Different mediums** (artwork, photos, videos, computer printouts)

- **Individual work** (written work, artwork)

- **Group work** (projects and other work related to group learning)

- **Reflexions** by the pupils themselves on how they see their progress (diaries)

- **Samples of processes** of how they have achieved their work (drafts)

- Portfolio work achieves several different **aims:**

- Pupils can **compare and comment** over time on where they have progressed the most

- **Weaknesses** can be **identified**, addressed and **remedied**

- It gives the teachers a good **overview** of the pupils' development

- It gives the parents a **summary** of their children's progress

PORTFOLIO Teacher's Book references:

- **Portfolio:** p. 24, 28, 30, 38, 54, 61

9. PROJECTS

- Projects are typically **task-oriented** rather than language-oriented. Pupils learn the language through doing something practical.

- Typically projects will involve one of the following tasks:

- **Research, Writing, Designing, Preparing, Performing, Making, Visiting.**

- In the final stage, pupils may **Present, Display, Perform** or even **Publish** their results.

- Examples of Projects are to be found in all units of this course.

PROJECTS Teacher's Book references:

- Projects: p. 24, 28, 31, 41, 53, 65, 73

10. POETRY

10.A. Why is poetry important in the language classroom?

- It can make us see things in new ways.
- It can be fun.
- It's different – it makes for a break from using the same old sentences about John doing this or that.

10.B. Reading a poem in class. Steps:

- Set the scene by giving background information
- Get the pupils to predict what vocabulary items might be included
- Do a picture dictation: describe what the poem contains and get the pupils to draw the scene
- Give them other background information about the author and period the poem is set in
- Present the poem as if it were a mini story before presenting them with the real thing
- Get pupils to scan poetry anthologies and present a poem that has inspired them
- Pupils may want to memorise poems they really like

10.C. Writing a poem. Examples of activities:

- Provide a poem and ask pupils to fill in the blanks
- Instant poetry: Give pupils clear instructions to write simple sentences about things around them. It's surprising how poetic young people can be.
- Get pupils to invent metaphors.
- Photocopy and give pupils cut up poems for them to re-order.
- Tell them about haiku (Japanese poems with a maximum of 17 syllables). See if they can write something in haiku.

11. DRAMA

Using drama in the classroom can be a

liberating experience. Pupils feel freer from cultural constraints and are more willing to experiment with language in different contexts. It has been found to be of particular benefit to shy pupils. The prerequisite is that will mutual trust and respect or it is unlikely the work to be useful.

Examples of Drama activities:

- **Role-plays:** Pupils act out discrete scenes with the aid of role-play cards.
- **Simulation:** This is a much more complex role-play involving maybe more characters within one imaginary setting.
- **Drama games:** By making pupils be funny characters with quirky lifestyles can be lots of fun.
- **Guided improvisation:** this is where the teacher sets the scene and pupils invent a story and characters, played by themselves. Guided and encouraged by the teacher a story should unfold.
- **Acting play scripts:** short sketches or plays are acted out in class or on school stage.
- **Prepared improvised drama:** pupils invent scenes and perform them in class or for the school.

PROJECTS Teacher's Book references:

- Role Plays: see under SPEAKING

12. CROSS-CURRICULAR APPROACH

Many of the activities in the Pupil's Book have a cross-curricular link. The links are stated in the Teacher's Book under each activity heading.

A cross-curricular approach is necessary for the development of the pupil's ability to examine issues and problems of everyday life more effectively. This also helps reduce knowledge-centred teaching and the use of school time can be maximised. The teacher's role is that of mediator in a learning process which becomes for the pupil more self-directed.

The following are suggested teaching strategies in order to achieve the pupils' holistic development as individuals and

social beings.

1. **Exploration and discovery:** This mainly requires the students' active participation. Pupils explore and acquire knowledge by themselves by learning "how to learn". Practices that create conditions making "discovery" possible include: observation, comparison, classification, exploration, prediction, discovery of time relations, comparison of events, problem solving, brainstorming etc.
2. **Presentations using appropriate teaching aids:** This can be done through use of artwork, photos, transparencies, videotapes, models and computer-based representations. Special care needs to be taken in discriminating what is presented through the computer and what through contact with the "real" world.
3. **Discussions between the teachers and the pupils or group discussions:** Discussions offer pupils opportunities to speculate, evaluate, draw conclusions and express views through the process of dialectic argumentation and debate.
4. **Collaborative teaching:** Dynamics developed by small groups of pupils working together are an ideal setting for collective data processing. These are particularly useful when undertaking projects which in most cases in this course are cross-curricular.
5. **Direct method of teaching – Narration:** Here the teacher intervenes directly during teaching, transferring his/her knowledge through speech.

CROSS-CURRICULAR TEACHING

Teacher's Book References:

Unit 1: Computer Studies, Geography; Unit 2: Maths, Geography; Unit 3 & 4: Geography; Unit 5: the Environment; Unit 7: History; Unit 10: History.

References

- Harmer J. (2005), *The Practice of English Language Teaching*, Longman
- Scrivener J. (2005), *Learning Teaching*, Macmillan
- BBC/British Council Teaching English website, www.teachingenglish.org.uk
- Gardner H. (1983), *Frames of Mind: The Theory of Multiple Intelligence*, Basic Books
- Goleman D. (1995), *Emotional Intelligence*, Bantam Books
- Tomlinson, C. (1995), *How to differentiate instruction in mixed-ability classrooms*. Alexandria, VA: Association for Supervision and Curriculum Development.
- CEFR - Common European Framework of References for Languages: Learning, teaching, assessment (2001) http://www.coe.int/t/dg4/linguistic/Source/Framework_EN.pdf μετάφραση στα Ελληνικά του CEFR (2001) <http://www.komvos.edu.gr/>
- ELP – European Language Portfolio (2001) <http://www.coe.int/lang>
- Ευρωπαϊκό Κέντρο Σύγχρονων Γλωσσών (ECML) <http://www.ecml.at>
- Παιδαγωγικό Ινστιτούτο <http://www.pi-schools.gr> (Αναλυτικά Προγράμματα Σπουδών και ΔΕΠΠΣ)
- ΥΠΕΠΘ <http://www.ypepth.gr> (Κρατικό Πιστοποιητικό Γλωσσομάθειας)